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Unit 1 - Exploring the Core

PDF Documents

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UNIT 1 EXPLORING THE CORE

Topic Investigation



THE FOUNDATIONS OF DEMOCRACY AND VOTING

Democracy, a form of government in which power ultimately comes from the people, primarily exercises this power through the process of voting. This fundamental act allows citizens to choose their leaders and influence policies by expressing their preferences via ballots. In this section, we will delve into the history of democratic governance and discuss how voting has evolved from ancient times to the modern day.



We begin by examining the early instances of democracy, such as those in ancient Athens, where citizens would cast their votes using stones to make decisions about laws and leadership. This method, though primitive by today's standards, underscores the enduring importance of each individual's decision in shaping the community's direction.



VOTING SYSTEM

Today, voting systems vary widely around the world but are generally classified into three types:

PROPORTIONAL REPRESENTATION SYSTEMS

Proportional representation systems, where parties gain seats in proportion to the number of votes they receive.

MAJORITARIAN SYSTEMS

This system is where the candidate or proposition receiving more than half of the votes wins.

PLURALITY SYSTEMS

Plurality systems, often known as "first-past-the-post," where the candidate with the most votes wins, even if they do not achieve a majority.



Each system has its advantages and challenges, influencing political outcomes and voter satisfaction differently. Understanding these systems will allow us to appreciate the complexities and responsibilities that come with the power to vote.



Inquiry & Reflection

Discussion question 1

How could different voting systems change election results? Discuss examples of majority vs. proportional representation systems.

Discussion question 2

What are the pros and cons of using technology in elections? Debate the benefits and risks of electronic voting machines.

